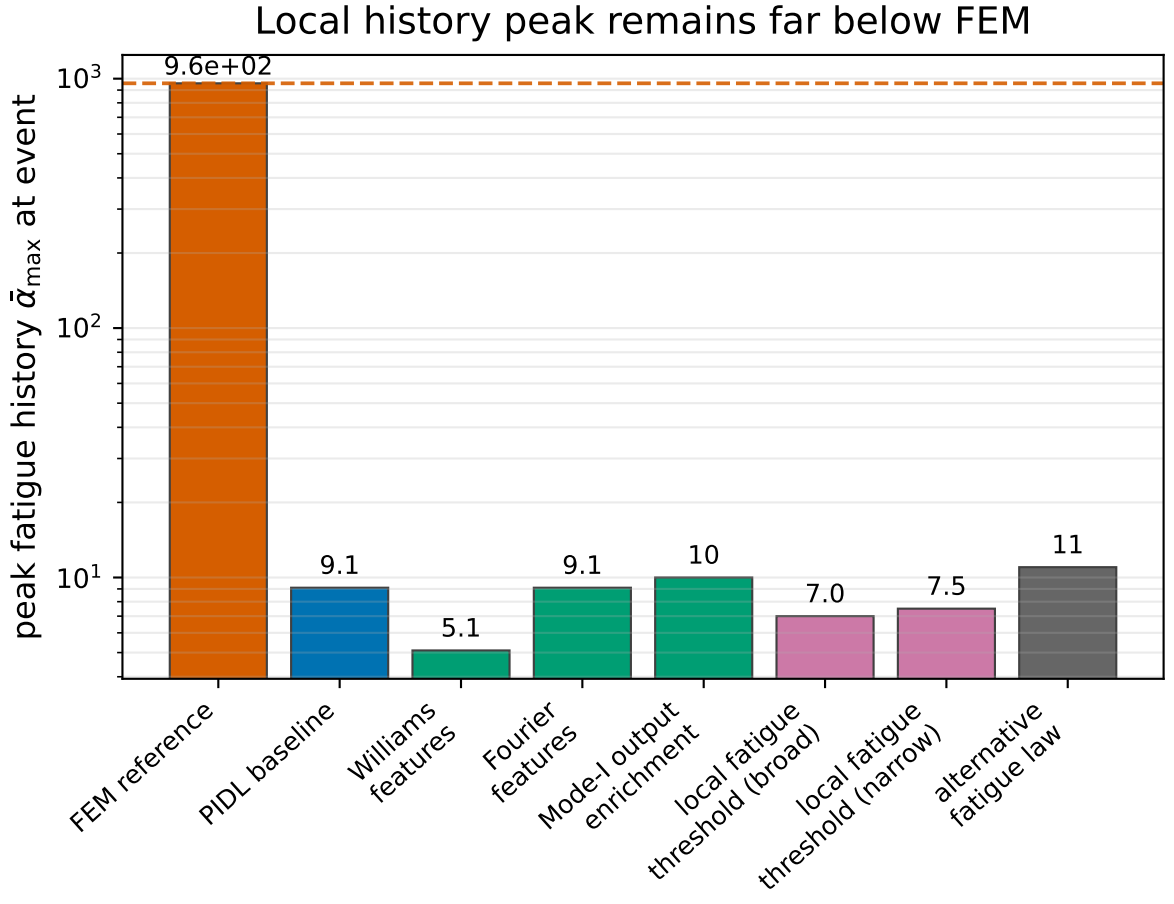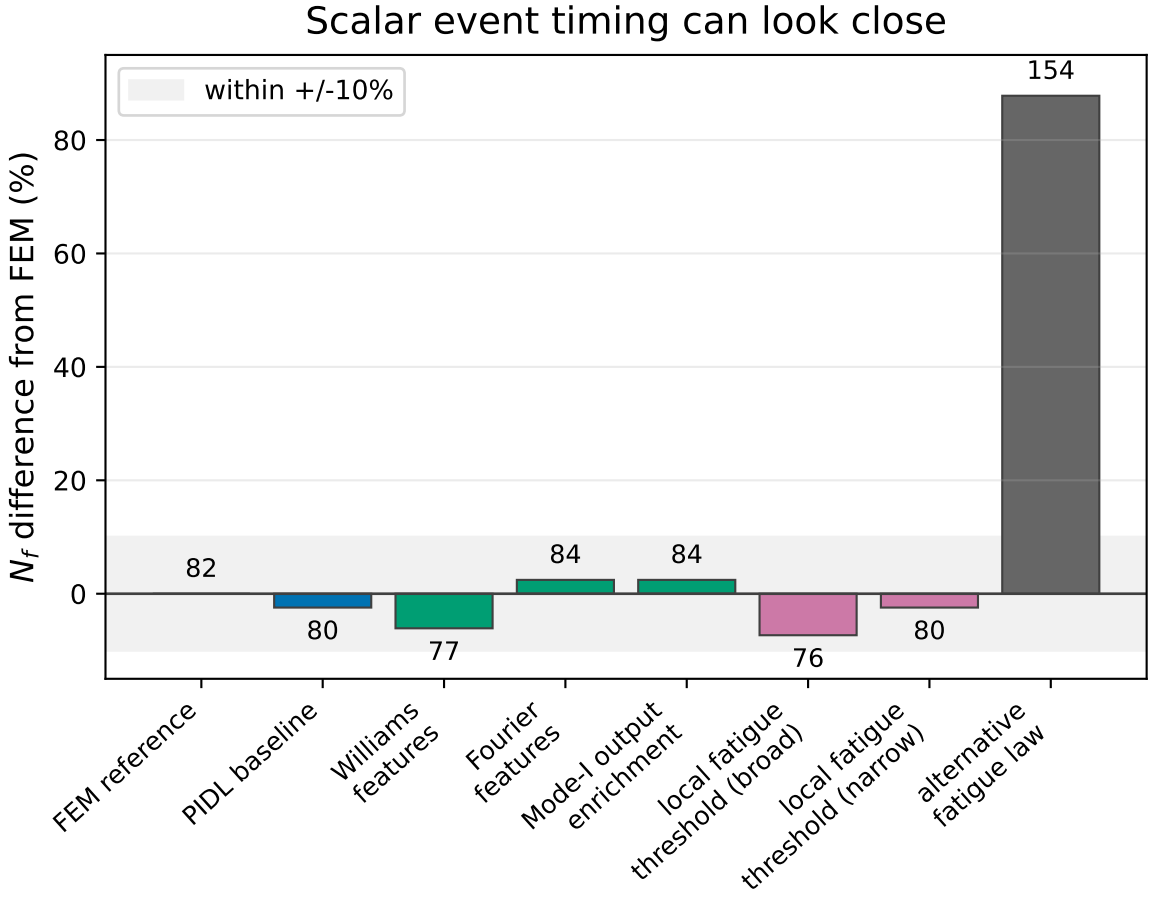Early method checks at $U_{\max} = 0.12$